

FOTD #008 SOLUTION

The Printer Has Opinions

CATEGORY Steganography, Cryptography

DIFFICULTY Medium

DATE 24/09/2026

FLAG INFOSEC_SIG{printer_has_opinions}

THE STRANGE NUMBERS

The three-number groups do not form a conventional encoded string. Keep them aside until the photograph has been examined.

LOOK AT THE IMAGE

The photograph looks ordinary, but the hints point towards image steganography. Hidden data has been embedded in the image rather than visibly printed on it.

PULL IT OUT

The hidden payload is a QR image stored in the least-significant bits of the RGB pixels. Extracting those bits reconstructs the QR.

READ THE QR

THE MANUAL IS YOUR BOOK.

THE NUMBERS ARE ADDRESSES.

P-S-W

TAKE THE FIRST LETTER OF EACH SELECTED WORD.

THE BOOK

P-S-W means Paragraph-Sentence-Word. Each three-number group points to one word in the manual.

PULL IT OUT

The first coordinate is 1-1-4, pointing to **its**. Repeating the lookup for all coordinates and taking first letters gives:

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FORMAT IT

Using the usual flag format specified in the challenge:

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TAKEAWAY

The image was the first hiding place. The recovered QR supplied the second-stage instruction, and the manual supplied the book-cipher text. The final first-letter extraction reveals the flag.